SOW TRUE SEED · DESIGN YOUR REGENERATIVE KITCHEN GARDEN

My Garden Plan

Goals → Site → Scale → Sketch → Crops, in that order. **The #1 mistake: planting before planning.**

"By the end of this season I want my garden to..."

_____

_____

1 Define Your Goals

Goals are the filter for every decision after this.

My top 2 reasons (circle):
save money · eat fresher · food security · learn a skill · heal the land · kids/family · beauty

10 things my household actually cooks with (not what you wish you cooked)

_____ _____
_____ _____
_____ _____
_____ _____
_____ _____

Honest hours/week: _____ Season budget: $_____

Constraints (renting, pets, kids, slope): _____

2 Pick Your Location

Sunniest spot with good drainage, nearest your kitchen door.

Score each spot 1–3	A	B	C
Sun 6+ hrs (check 9am · noon · 4pm)			
Water near spigot, no pooling			
Access close to kitchen door			
Soil tests below			
Total → highest wins			

Quick soil tests

- **Compaction:** push rebar in — stops at ____ in.
- **Drainage:** fill a 12" hole — empties in ____ hrs (1–4 ideal)
- **Worms** per shovelful ____ (5+ = healthy) · then look, feel, smell

Zone _____ Last spring frost _____ First fall frost _____

almanac.com/gardening/frostdates · Sun Seeker app · call 811 before digging

3 Get a Rough Idea of Scale

Inputs: goals + time + site. Rule of thumb: ~30 min per bed per week.

Model	Beds (4×10 ft)	Growing space	Time / week
Starter	4–6	160–240 sq ft	1.5–2 hrs
Family	10–14	400–560 sq ft	3–4 hrs
Self-sufficiency	18–24	720–960 sq ft	5–8 hrs

Beds **4 ft wide** (reach the middle) · paths **2–3 ft** · run beds **north–south** (across the slope if sloped)

"My garden is _____ sq ft with _____ beds."

When in doubt, go smaller. A small garden run well beats a big one that overwhelms you.

Action: mark the footprint with a hose or string and stand inside it.

5 Crops & Calendar

Start with your Foundation & Meal Maker staples. Count back from frost dates.

Top 5 crops	Cool / Warm	Start indoors	Transplant / Sow

Cool season (around frost): kale, collards, lettuce, peas, carrots, beets, onions, garlic · **Warm season** (after last frost): tomatoes, beans, squash, sweet potatoes, okra, corn

Succession = no empty beds: garlic → fall carrots · spring peas → summer beans · lettuce → tomatoes. Re-sow lettuce monthly, beans every 2–3 wks.

4 Design & Sketch

Pencil — erase and rearrange freely.

Place in this order:

1. **Water** — spigot, rain tank, flow
2. **Zones** — daily crops closest
3. **Beds & paths** — 4 ft / 2–3 ft
4. **Compost, gate, trellis**
5. **Plants** — annuals; perennials on edges

Also mark: house, sun, water arrows, wind.

Build first (phase 1):

_____

Win: a labeled sketch someone else could understand.



Winter to-do

Pick ONE to do this week.

- ☐ Order seeds (buy here today!)
- ☐ Source compost & mulch
- ☐ Rake fall leaves for mulch
- ☐ Flag the spot, take sun photos
- ☐ Draw the basemap
- ☐ Sheet-mulch your first beds

Healthy-garden habits

- Walk it 3× a week
- Mix in flowers & herbs for beneficial insects
- Pests: handpick → barrier → soap → organic spray

4 Principles of Living Soil

1. **Minimize disturbance** — build beds once, never till
2. **Keep it covered** — leaves, straw, clippings, chips
3. **Keep roots in the ground** — no bare beds
4. **Add life** — compost, worm castings, diversity

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Book a Free Garden Strategy Session

Turn this sheet into a real plan for your yard. We'll map your goals, challenges & next steps.
radical-gardening.com/start